THE WAYNE FACTORY

The 400-Day Plan

Day 1: Saturday 7 November 2026 → Day 400: Saturday 11 December 2027

- Learn to make great animations yourself (Premiere Pro + After Effects)
- Homework every school night + 1 hour on Sunday
- Paper Trail: 1 Short a day — the 30-day test first
- Never two short nights in a row

Goals:

- Learn to make **great animations yourself** in Premiere Pro and After Effects.
- Do your **homework every school night** (30 min) plus **1 hour on Sunday**.
- Keep your channels growing while you learn.

1. The honest truth (read this once)

- **The videos the app makes are a start, not the finish.** The drawings I make in code are simple. Channels like Kurzgesagt, MagnatesMedia or Johnny Harris look great because a person animated them by hand. **That person can be you.** It takes months, not days. After 400 days of practice, you can be really good.
- **Your time is small:** school 8:00–13:30, work until 22:00, home at 22:10. So every minute in this plan has one job. If your hours change, tell me and I will change the plan.
- **Late nights, the smart way:** 2 am on two school nights a week is something you can keep doing. 2 am *every* night usually ends with getting sick or quitting within a month. So the plan swaps long nights and recovery nights.
- **School is not optional.** If your grades drop, the plan has failed, even if a video goes viral. The school hour comes **first** every day.
- **Keep posting while you learn.** Wayne Factory keeps making Shorts. Your animations replace them step by step.
- **The software costs money.** Adobe Premiere Pro + After Effects need a Creative Cloud plan. Ask Adobe for the **student price**, which is much cheaper. Free option: **DaVinci Resolve** (free, with Fusion for animation) and **Blender** (free, 2D and 3D). The plan works with both; the tutorials below are for Adobe.
- **Your PC:** your i7-8700 and GTX 1630 are fine for 2D animation. Check your RAM (Settings → System → About). After Effects wants **16 GB**, and 32 GB is better. If you have 8 GB, RAM is the first thing to buy (around 40–60 euro).

2. Your day

Every school day (Monday – Friday)

Time	What
07:00	Wake up, water, shower. **Same time every school day, no snooze.**
07:20	Check YouTube numbers (max 5 min), breakfast
07:40	Go to school, **audiobook** on the way
08:00 – 13:30	School. In breaks: 10 min looking at one great animation ("how was this made?")
13:30 → 22:00	Lunch, then work (audiobook in one ear if your job allows it)
22:10	Home, eat something, water
22:20 – 22:50	**HOMEWORK (30 min)**, phone in another room (section 4)
22:50 → end of night	**EDITING / LEARNING**: until the time in the table below

How late each night

Night	Work until	Sleep	Why
Monday	**02:00**	5 h	long night
Tuesday	**00:30**	6.5 h	recovery night
Wednesday	**02:00**	5 h	long night
Thursday	**00:30**	6.5 h	recovery night
Friday	**02:30**	sleep in	no school tomorrow
Saturday	**02:30**	sleep in	no school tomorrow
Sunday	**23:00**	early	school tomorrow

Never two short nights in a row. That is what keeps you going for 400 days.

Sunday

Time	What
10:00 – 11:00	**School hour** for the week ahead (tests, projects)
11:00 – 13:00	Finish and export videos, **schedule the week's Shorts** in YouTube Studio
13:00 – 13:30	**Weekly review** (section 7): screenshot of YouTube Studio, send it to Claude
Rest of the day	**Free.** Friends, family, rest.

Every week: about 3.5 hours homework + about 20 hours editing/learning.

Late-night rules

1. **No coffee or energy drinks after 20:00.**
2. **Learn new things before 01:00**, while your brain still works. After 01:00 only do easy work: exporting, captions, sorting files.
3. **Night mode / dim screen** after 23:00.
4. **Stop signs: go back to 00:30 every night for one week** if you fall asleep in class, a grade drops, you get sick often, or you are editing slower than before.

Exam weeks

- Homework: **2 hours a night**. Editing: **0–20 minutes**, and lights off by **00:30**.
- Videos: post Shorts that are already made (keep **5 ready** before every exam period).

3. What you learn: the animation path (400 days)

The rule: watch 1 thing, make 1 thing. Never only watch. Every tutorial gets copied in your own project the same week.

Phase 1 — Days 1-30 (7 Nov - 6 Dec 2026): Premiere Pro basics

- **Learn:** cutting, the timeline, audio levels, **keyframes** (position, scale, opacity), captions, export settings for Shorts.
- **Watch:** Gavin Herman's beginner Premiere course (one chapter a night), then Kyler Holland's videos on the newest Premiere features.
- **Project of the month:** remake our **Eiffel Tower Short** in Premiere yourself. Use real photos with slow zooms (Ken Burns), and captions that pop.
- **Done when:** you can make a 30-second Short from photos + voice in under 2 hours.

Phase 2 — Days 31-100 (7 Dec 2026 - 14 Feb 2027): After Effects foundations

- **Learn, one per week:**
- Interface, layers, keyframes
- **Easing and the Graph Editor** — the secret of smooth animation
- Shape layers + Trim Paths (lines that draw themselves)
- Text animators (words that slam, type and bounce)
- Masks and track mattes
- Parenting + null objects
- Pre-comps
- Motion blur
- Sound design (whoosh, hit, riser)
- A full 15-second piece

- **Watch:** Adobe's free After Effects workshop (Kyle Hamrick), Ben Marriott (beginner videos), Jake in Motion (tips and tricks).
- **Weekly mini projects:** the Paper Trail logo animation · a money counter · a map line from London to Paris · a "SOLD" stamp slam · a newspaper headline zoom · a bar chart that grows.
- **Done when:** your stamp slam and counter look **smoother** than the ones in our Shorts.

Phase 3 — Days 101–200 (15 Feb – 25 May 2027): 2D motion graphics for your channels

- **Learn:**
- flat-design scenes made from shapes (SonduckFilm's Kurzgesagt-style tutorials)
- 2.5D camera and parallax (photos with depth)
- Flat Pack FX tutorials (newspapers, graphs, timelines)
- **basic expressions:** `wiggle`, `loopOut`, a number counter
- colour palettes and fonts
- **Project: one fully animated 30-second Short every week**, made by you. Post it on Paper Trail or The Forgotten Lab.
- **Done when:** your own animated Shorts get the same or a better **average % viewed** than the app's Shorts.

Phase 4 — Days 201–300 (26 May – 2 Sep 2027): characters, maps and speed

- **Learn:**
- **Duik Angela** (free character rigging): a simple character that walks, points and talks
- 3D layers + camera for maps and "flying" over a scene
- **Essential Graphics / MOGRT templates**: your own template pack (titles, captions, counter, map, stamp) so a Short takes 2–3 hours, not 8
- **Summer = more time:** do 2 animated Shorts a week, plus your first **animated long video** (5–8 minutes) for Paper Trail.
- **Project:** a channel **mascot / host character** for Paper Trail or The Forgotten Lab.

Phase 5 — Days 301–400 (3 Sep – 11 Dec 2027): your own style

- **Each month:** pick 30 seconds from a great animated channel and **copy it exactly** in your project. This is practice only; **never upload a copy**. Then use what you learned in your own video.
- **Make:** 2–3 animated Shorts a week + 1 animated long video a month.
- **Build a portfolio:** your 10 best animations in one reel. With this you can also **earn money as a freelance animator** (Fiverr, Upwork, local businesses). This can pay faster than YouTube.
- **Day 400 goal:** you make a 30-second animated Short in about 2 hours, it looks professional, and your channels grow from it.

4. Homework (every school night, before anything else)

1. **22:20 – 22:50: homework first**, whatever is due tomorrow.
2. **No homework?** 10 min read today's notes, 20 min exercises in your **weakest subject**.
3. **Sunday hour:** plan the week. Tests, projects, anything big gets started on Sunday, not the night before.
4. **Before a test:** the exam-week rules in section 2.
5. **Phone in another room.** 30 minutes of real focus beats 2 hours with the phone.
6. **Every month:** look at your grades. If one drops, homework time goes up to 1 hour a night until it's back.

5. The channels while you learn

Channel	What happens	Who makes the videos
Paper Trail (main)	1 Short a day at 19:00, about 30 s, famous true money/scam stories	Claude makes them now (animated, like the Apple $800 Short) → **your animations from day 101**
The Forgotten Lab	3 Shorts a week (science + psychology)	Wayne Factory now → your animations from day 150
History	3 Shorts a week	Wayne Factory
Hot Mic Moments, Chat Lost It	Only if Clip Factory runs by itself; check 10 min a day	Clip Factory
Albanian channel	Start on day 200 with your best animated videos in Albanian	you

First: the 30-day test (7 Nov – 6 Dec 2026). Post **1 Paper Trail Short every day at 19:00**, scheduled each Sunday. Don't judge the channel before day 30. On day 30 we look at the numbers together and decide: keep going, change the style, or stop. The other channels wait until the test is over.

What we learned from your numbers: the Eiffel Tower Short (famous true story, strong first line) got 1.1k views in 3 hours. The Binance crypto-news Short got 1 view. **Famous true stories + about 30 seconds + a loop ending** is your formula until the numbers say otherwise.

6. The weekly plan (after homework)

Night	Until	What
Monday	02:00	**Learn:** this week's tutorial, copy it step by step (new things before 01:00)
Tuesday	00:30	Practise the new skill in a small test
Wednesday	02:00	**Make:** use the skill in this week's project / Short
Thursday	00:30	Sound, captions, small fixes
Friday	02:30	**Big block:** finish the week's project
Saturday	02:30	**Big block:** next week's video, extra practice, portfolio
Sunday	—	Export, schedule the Shorts, weekly review (section 2)

7. Weekly review (Sunday, 30 min)

1. **Animation:** what did I learn this week? Put the project in a folder called "Portfolio" if it's good.
2. **School:** did I do homework every night + the Sunday hour? Any test coming? Then switch to exam rules.
3. **Sleep:** any stop signs (section 2)? Then one week of 00:30 nights.
4. **YouTube:** which Short had the highest **average % viewed**? Where did people swipe away? Use that in the next video.
5. Write **3 lessons** in one note. Read last week's lessons first.

8. Milestones

Day	Date	Animation	School	Channels
30	6 Dec 2026	Eiffel Short remade in Premiere by you	homework every night, no grade drops	**30-day test done:** 30 Shorts posted, decision made together
100	14 Feb 2027	AE basics: counter, stamp, map line, logo done	grades same or better	best Short over 10k views
200	25 May 2027	15+ Shorts animated by you	end-of-year exams passed well	Paper Trail growing from your animations
300	2 Sep 2027	character rig + template pack + first animated long video	summer homework done	1 channel near monetization
400	11 Dec 2027	own style, portfolio reel, first freelance client	strong grades	1–2 channels monetized if the videos hit

9. Reading: 100 books

100 books in 400 days = 1 book every 4 days. That needs about **1 hour of reading or listening every day.** It is only possible with **audiobooks** on the way to school, at lunch, and at work if your job allows it. Listen at 1.25–1.5x speed.

A realistic minimum is **1 book a week (57 books)**. The other 43 are a bonus.

Smart trick: many books below are also **video ideas**. The fraud books are Paper Trail episodes. The history books are History episodes. Reading = research.

Free, legal online

- **Project Gutenberg** (gutenberg.org): old books, free forever.
- **OpenStax** (openstax.org): free university textbooks.

- **Adobe's user guides**: free.

- The History of the Standard Oil Company – Ida Tarbell (Gutenberg) — *Paper Trail gold*

- Extraordinary Popular Delusions and the Madness of Crowds – Charles Mackay (Gutenberg) — *bubbles and manias*
- Other People's Money – Louis Brandeis (Gutenberg)
- The Art of Money Getting – P. T. Barnum (Gutenberg)
- The Way to Wealth – Benjamin Franklin (Gutenberg)
- The Autobiography of Benjamin Franklin (Gutenberg)
- The Richest Man in Babylon – George S. Clason
- How to Live on 24 Hours a Day – Arnold Bennett (Gutenberg) — *perfect for your busy life*
- Meditations – Marcus Aurelius (Gutenberg)
- Letters from a Stoic – Seneca
- The Art of War – Sun Tzu (Gutenberg)
- The Prince – Niccolò Machiavelli (Gutenberg)
- Self-Help – Samuel Smiles (Gutenberg)
- As a Man Thinketh – James Allen (Gutenberg)
- Acres of Diamonds – Russell Conwell (Gutenberg)
- The Science of Getting Rich – Wallace Wattles (Gutenberg)
- The Jungle – Upton Sinclair (Gutenberg)
- The Wealth of Nations – Adam Smith (Gutenberg; read the famous chapters)
- The Theory of the Leisure Class – Thorstein Veblen (Gutenberg)
- The Histories – Herodotus (Gutenberg)
- The Decline and Fall of the Roman Empire, vol. 1 – Edward Gibbon (Gutenberg)
- On the Origin of Species – Charles Darwin (Gutenberg)
- Relativity: The Special and General Theory – Albert Einstein (Gutenberg)
- The Almanack of Naval Ravikant – Eric Jorgenson (free official e-book)
- OpenStax: Principles of Economics
- OpenStax: Principles of Finance
- OpenStax: U.S. History
- OpenStax: World History, Volume 1

- OpenStax: World History, Volume 2
- OpenStax: Astronomy
- OpenStax: Biology
- OpenStax: Psychology
- Adobe Premiere User Guide (helpx.adobe.com)
- Adobe After Effects User Guide (helpx.adobe.com)

Buy, borrow from a library, or get the audiobook

Fraud and collapse (Paper Trail episodes)

1. Bad Blood – John Carreyrou (Theranos)
2. The Smartest Guys in the Room – Bethany McLean & Peter Elkind (Enron)
3. Billion Dollar Whale – Tom Wright & Bradley Hope (1MDB)
4. Going Infinite – Michael Lewis (FTX)
5. The Big Short – Michael Lewis
6. Liar's Poker – Michael Lewis
7. When Genius Failed – Roger Lowenstein
8. Too Big to Fail – Andrew Ross Sorkin
9. Barbarians at the Gate – Bryan Burrough & John Helyar
10. Den of Thieves – James B. Stewart
11. Super Pumped – Mike Isaac (Uber)
12. The Spider Network – David Enrich
13. Number Go Up – Zeke Faux
14. The Cult of We – Eliot Brown & Maureen Farrell (WeWork)

History (History episodes)

1. Sapiens – Yuval Noah Harari
2. Guns, Germs, and Steel – Jared Diamond
3. The Silk Roads – Peter Frankopan
4. SPQR – Mary Beard
5. The Guns of August – Barbara Tuchman
6. The Rise and Fall of the Third Reich – William Shirer (long; use audiobook)
7. 1491 – Charles C. Mann
8. Team of Rivals – Doris Kearns Goodwin

Science (The Forgotten Lab episodes)

1. A Short History of Nearly Everything – Bill Bryson
2. Cosmos – Carl Sagan
3. The Gene – Siddhartha Mukherjee
4. Astrophysics for People in a Hurry – Neil deGrasse Tyson
5. The Immortal Life of Henrietta Lacks – Rebecca Skloot
6. What If? – Randall Munroe
7. The Disappearing Spoon – Sam Kean

Story, scripts and attention (better videos)

1. Made to Stick – Chip & Dan Heath
2. Contagious – Jonah Berger
3. Save the Cat! – Blake Snyder
4. Story – Robert McKee
5. Storyworthy – Matthew Dicks
6. Influence – Robert Cialdini
7. Hooked – Nir Eyal
8. Building a StoryBrand – Donald Miller
9. Everybody Writes – Ann Handley
10. On Writing Well – William Zinsser

Editing and design

1. In the Blink of an Eye – Walter Murch
2. The Animator's Survival Kit – Richard Williams
3. Grammar of the Edit – Roy Thompson & Christopher Bowen
4. The Non-Designer's Design Book – Robin Williams
5. Steal Like an Artist – Austin Kleon
6. Show Your Work! – Austin Kleon
7. The Creative Act – Rick Rubin

Business and money

1. $100M Offers – Alex Hormozi
2. $100M Leads – Alex Hormozi
3. The Psychology of Money – Morgan Housel
4. Rich Dad Poor Dad – Robert Kiyosaki
5. The Millionaire Next Door – Thomas Stanley & William Danko
6. Zero to One – Peter Thiel
7. The Lean Startup – Eric Ries
8. The 4-Hour Workweek – Tim Ferriss
9. Shoe Dog – Phil Knight
10. The Everything Store – Brad Stone

Discipline and mind (for a 400-day run)

1. Atomic Habits – James Clear
2. Deep Work – Cal Newport
3. Can't Hurt Me – David Goggins
4. The War of Art – Steven Pressfield
5. Ego Is the Enemy – Ryan Holiday
6. The Obstacle Is the Way – Ryan Holiday
7. Thinking, Fast and Slow – Daniel Kahneman
8. Range – David Epstein
9. Mindset – Carol Dweck
10. Four Thousand Weeks – Oliver Burkeman

Order: mix them. Every month read: 1 fraud book, 1 history or science book, 1 story/editing book, 1 business or mind book. Start with #8 (How to Live on 24 Hours a Day), #91 (Atomic Habits) and #35

(Bad Blood).

10. Rules for 400 days

1. **Homework first, sleep second, animation third.**
2. **Watch 1, make 1.** Every tutorial gets used the same week.
3. **Post on schedule, even if it isn't perfect.** Animation 50 will be much better than animation 1.
4. **Never upload someone else's work or a copy.** Copy only to practise, privately.
5. **Look at the numbers on Sunday, not every hour.**
6. **Missed a day? Don't miss two.**
7. **Never two short nights in a row.** Watch the stop signs.
8. **Exam weeks are school weeks.** Keep 5 Shorts ready before each one.

You don't become a great animator in one month. You get there by being a little better every week for 400 days, and this plan is built for that.

10b. The 400-day tracker

Tick (✓) each day when you did **homework + your editing block**. Gold boxes = milestones (day 30, 100, 200, 300, 400).

Phase 1: Premiere basics | Phase 2: After Effects basics | Phase 3: motion graphics | Phase 4: characters + speed | Phase 5: your style

November 2026

1 7 S	2 8 S	3 9 M	4 10 T	5 11 W	6 12 T	7 13 F	8 14 S	9 15 S	10 16 M	11 17 T
12 18 W	13 19 T	14 20 F	15 21 S	16 22 S	17 23 M	18 24 T	19 25 W	20 26 T	21 27 F	22 28 S
23 29 S	24 30 M									

December 2026

25 1 T	26 2 W	27 3 T	28 4 F	29 5 S	30 6 S	31 7 M	32 8 T	33 9 W	34 10 T	35 11 F
36 12 S	37 13 S	38 14 M	39 15 T	40 16 W	41 17 T	42 18 F	43 19 S	44 20 S	45 21 M	46 22 T
47 23 W	48 24 T	49 25 F	50 26 S	51 27 S	52 28 M	53 29 T	54 30 W	55 31 T		

January 2027

56 1 F	57 2 S	58 3 S	59 4 M	60 5 T	61 6 W	62 7 T	63 8 F	64 9 S	65 10 S	66 11 M
67 12 T	68 13 W	69 14 T	70 15 F	71 16 S	72 17 S	73 18 M	74 19 T	75 20 W	76 21 T	77 22 F
78 23 S	79 24 S	80 25 M	81 26 T	82 27 W	83 28 T	84 29 F	85 30 S	86 31 S		

February 2027

87 1 M	88 2 T	89 3 W	90 4 T	91 5 F	92 6 S	93 7 S	94 8 M	95 9 T	96 10 W	97 11 T
98 12 F	99 13 S	100 14 S	101 15 M	102 16 T	103 17 W	104 18 T	105 19 F	106 20 S	107 21 S	108 22 M
109 23 T	110 24 W	111 25 T	112 26 F	113 27 S	114 28 S					

March 2027

115 1 M	116 2 T	117 3 W	118 4 T	119 5 F	120 6 S	121 7 S	122 8 M	123 9 T	124 10 W	125 11 T
126 12 F	127 13 S	128 14 S	129 15 M	130 16 T	131 17 W	132 18 T	133 19 F	134 20 S	135 21 S	136 22 M
137 23 T	138 24 W	139 25 T	140 26 F	141 27 S	142 28 S	143 29 M	144 30 T	145 31 W		

April 2027

146 1 T	147 2 F	148 3 S	149 4 S	150 5 M	151 6 T	152 7 W	153 8 T	154 9 F	155 10 S	156 11 S
157 12 M	158 13 T	159 14 W	160 15 T	161 16 F	162 17 S	163 18 S	164 19 M	165 20 T	166 21 W	167 22 T
168 23 F	169 24 S	170 25 S	171 26 M	172 27 T	173 28 W	174 29 T	175 30 F			

May 2027

176 1 S	177 2 S	178 3 M	179 4 T	180 5 W	181 6 T	182 7 F	183 8 S	184 9 S	185 10 M	186 11 T
187 12 W	188 13 T	189 14 F	190 15 S	191 16 S	192 17 M	193 18 T	194 19 W	195 20 T	196 21 F	197 22 S
198 23 S	199 24 M	200 25 T	201 26 W	202 27 T	203 28 F	204 29 S	205 30 S	206 31 M		

June 2027

207 1 T	208 2 W	209 3 T	210 4 F	211 5 S	212 6 S	213 7 M	214 8 T	215 9 W	216 10 T	217 11 F
218 12 S	219 13 S	220 14 M	221 15 T	222 16 W	223 17 T	224 18 F	225 19 S	226 20 S	227 21 M	228 22 T
229 23 W	230 24 T	231 25 F	232 26 S	233 27 S	234 28 M	235 29 T	236 30 W			

July 2027

237 1 T	238 2 F	239 3 S	240 4 S	241 5 M	242 6 T	243 7 W	244 8 T	245 9 F	246 10 S	247 11 S
248 12 M	249 13 T	250 14 W	251 15 T	252 16 F	253 17 S	254 18 S	255 19 M	256 20 T	257 21 W	258 22 T
259 23 F	260 24 S	261 25 S	262 26 M	263 27 T	264 28 W	265 29 T	266 30 F	267 31 S		

August 2027

268 1 S	269 2 M	270 3 T	271 4 W	272 5 T	273 6 F	274 7 S	275 8 S	276 9 M	277 10 T	278 11 W
279 12 T	280 13 F	281 14 S	282 15 S	283 16 M	284 17 T	285 18 W	286 19 T	287 20 F	288 21 S	289 22 S
290 23 M	291 24 T	292 25 W	293 26 T	294 27 F	295 28 S	296 29 S	297 30 M	298 31 T		

September 2027

299 1 W	300 2 T	301 3 F	302 4 S	303 5 S	304 6 M	305 7 T	306 8 W	307 9 T	308 10 F	309 11 S
310 12 S	311 13 M	312 14 T	313 15 W	314 16 T	315 17 F	316 18 S	317 19 S	318 20 M	319 21 T	320 22 W
321 23 T	322 24 F	323 25 S	324 26 S	325 27 M	326 28 T	327 29 W	328 30 T			

October 2027

329 1 F	**330** 2 S	**331** 3 S	**332** 4 M	**333** 5 T	**334** 6 W	**335** 7 T	**336** 8 F	**337** 9 S	**338** 10 S	**339** 11 M
340 12 T	**341** 13 W	**342** 14 T	**343** 15 F	**344** 16 S	**345** 17 S	**346** 18 M	**347** 19 T	**348** 20 W	**349** 21 T	**350** 22 F
351 23 S	**352** 24 S	**353** 25 M	**354** 26 T	**355** 27 W	**356** 28 T	**357** 29 F	**358** 30 S	**359** 31 S		

November 2027

360 1 M	**361** 2 T	**362** 3 W	**363** 4 T	**364** 5 F	**365** 6 S	**366** 7 S	**367** 8 M	**368** 9 T	**369** 10 W	**370** 11 T
371 12 F	**372** 13 S	**373** 14 S	**374** 15 M	**375** 16 T	**376** 17 W	**377** 18 T	**378** 19 F	**379** 20 S	**380** 21 S	**381** 22 M
382 23 T	**383** 24 W	**384** 25 T	**385** 26 F	**386** 27 S	**387** 28 S	**388** 29 M	**389** 30 T			

December 2027

390 1 W	**391** 2 T	**392** 3 F	**393** 4 S	**394** 5 S	**395** 6 M	**396** 7 T	**397** 8 W	**398** 9 T	**399** 10 F	**400** 11 S